

Filing Checklist — I-539

Application to Extend/Change Nonimmigrant Status · Form edition: 08/28/24 · <https://www.uscis.gov/i-539>

1. Before you send it

- Review the filled-out PDF field by field — compare it against your original documents (passport, certificates, resident card) before printing.
- Confirm you're using the form edition listed above — USCIS rejects forms with an expired edition. Check the current date at <https://www.uscis.gov/i-539>.
- Gather the supporting evidence required by the official instructions ([form instructions](#)) — this checklist only covers signing, filing, and tracking, not the list of attachments.

2. Who needs to sign, and where

Who	Where (on the form)	When it's required
Applicant / Petitioner — you	Part 5	Always required.
Interpreter	Part 6	Only if someone translated the form and questions for you into another language.
Preparer (attorney or other third party)	Part 7	Only if someone other than you filled out the form on your behalf.

Each person signs only their own section. An attorney or preparer may NOT sign the applicant's section, and the applicant must not sign for the interpreter or preparer.

3. How to sign correctly

NOTICE — New USCIS rule effective 07/10/2026: invalid signatures can now lead to DENIAL of the request even after it has been accepted and processed (previously it was only rejected at intake) — with loss of the fee paid. Follow the rules below with extra care.

- **Valid:** an original signature made by hand, in pen ("wet" ink), by the person themselves. After signing by hand, you may submit the original, or a scanned/photocopied/faxed copy of that page — as long as the original wet-ink signature exists and is kept by you.
- **Every filing requires its own fresh signature.** Do not reuse a page already signed for another form, nor a saved signature image — even if it's the same person signing several petitions, each one needs its own physical signature.
- **NOT valid:** a typed name on the signature line, a stamp, an electronic/software signature (DocuSign, Adobe Sign, etc. — that only applies to forms designed for fully online filing, not a printed PDF), or anyone signing on someone else's behalf (e.g., an attorney signing for the applicant).
- If filing online through my.uscis.gov, the system's own electronic signature is accepted — this "wet ink" rule applies to paper filings.

4. Date of signature

Write the date in MM/DD/YYYY format (U.S. standard — month first), next to your signature. The date must be the actual day you signed the document, not the mailing date. If the form takes a while to be mailed after signing, double-check whether the official instructions require signing again closer to the mailing date.

5. Filing fee

Filing method	Amount
Online (my.uscis.gov)	US\$ 420
Paper (mail)	US\$ 470

Desconto de \$50 no online, em vigor desde 01/04/2024. A maioria das categorias cobertas pelos 4 serviços deste app (extensão, mudança para B-2/F-1/F-2) pode ser protocolada online.

Payable to: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. Confirm the current fee before mailing at uscis.gov/g-1055 — fees change periodically.

6. Where and how to send it

- **Online:** <https://my.uscis.gov/> — create or access your myUSCIS account and follow the electronic filing process.
- **Paper (mail):** the exact lockbox address depends on your state/location and the eligibility category selected, and can change over time — do NOT use an old or memorized address. Confirm the correct address for your specific case on the form's official page (<https://www.uscis.gov/i-539>, "Direct Filing Addresses" / "Where to File" tab) before mailing it.

7. Processing time

Processing time varies by category and by the USCIS service center or office handling your case, and changes month to month — so it isn't a fixed number here. Check the current estimated time at <https://egov.uscis.gov/processing-times/>: select Form I-539 and the office/service center shown on your Receipt Notice (Form I-797, Notice of Action) once your filing has been accepted.

8. How to track your case status

- Once USCIS accepts your filing, you'll receive a **Receipt Number** — 13 characters: 3 letters identifying the processing center (e.g., MSC, EAC, WAC, LIN, SRC, NBC, IOE) followed by 10 digits — printed at the top of Form I-797, Notice of Action, mailed to you (or available in your myUSCIS account, if you filed online).
- Check your status anytime at egov.uscis.gov/casestatus, by entering the receipt number (no spaces or dashes).
- If you filed through my.uscis.gov, status and updates also appear directly in your account, with optional email/SMS notifications.
- Keep the receipt number — you'll need it to check status, call the USCIS Contact Center, and to link related filings (e.g., a pending I-765/I-131 filed together with an I-485).

9. If you move after filing

By law (INA 265/266(b)), you are required to report any change of address to USCIS within 10 days of moving — this applies even while your case is already filed and pending, and even if you've already reported your new address on another case. In 2025, DHS publicly announced it will enforce this requirement more strictly.

- **Online (recommended):** through your USCIS account (my.uscis.gov) at uscis.gov/addresschange.
Important: when changing your address through the account, also enter the receipt number of EACH pending case — updating only the account's "general" address does not automatically update cases already filed.
- **By paper:** Form AR-11 (Alien's Change of Address Card) by mail, if you'd rather not use the online account — this also satisfies the legal requirement.
- **Consequence of not reporting it:** a fine of up to \$200 and/or up to 30 days in jail (Class B misdemeanor, INA 266(b)), plus the much more common practical risk of missing important USCIS correspondence — an interview notice, a Request for Evidence (RFE), or the case decision itself — which can cause delays or even a denial for not responding in time.

This checklist is a support guide and does not replace the form's official instructions or legal advice. Fees, addresses, and processing times change — always double-check at uscis.gov before filing.